

Daily Integral - Hard

$$\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \cos(\sin(x)) e^{\cos(x)} dx$$

This problem was generously submitted by Leonz on <https://dailyintegral.com>.

Solution

Since by Euler's formula, $e^{ix} = \cos(x) + i \sin(x)$, we can find that $e^{e^{ix}} = e^{\cos(x) + i \sin(x)} = e^{\cos(x)} e^{i \sin(x)}$. Using Euler's formula again, we get that $e^{e^{ix}} = e^{\cos(x)} (\cos(\sin(x)) + i \sin(\sin(x)))$. Hence, the integrand is simply the real part of the expression, and we can make the substitution

$$\begin{aligned} & \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \Re(e^{e^{ix}}) dx \\ &= \Re\left(\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} e^{e^{ix}} dx\right). \end{aligned}$$

To evaluate this integral, we use Feynman's trick to introduce a parameter:

$$I(t) = \Re\left(\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} e^{te^{ix}} dx\right).$$

Note that the original integral is given when $t = 1$. Now, we can differentiate with respect to t :

$$\begin{aligned} I'(t) &= \Re\left(\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{te^{ix}} dx\right) \\ &= \Re\left(\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} e^{ix} e^{te^{ix}} dx\right). \end{aligned}$$

Now, take $u = e^{ix}$. Then, $1/i du = e^{ix} dx$, and $u \in [-1, -1]$:

$$\begin{aligned} I'(t) &= \Re\left(\frac{1}{i} \int_{-1}^{-1} e^{tu} du\right) \\ &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

Now we can find that

$$\begin{aligned} I(t) &= \int I'(t) dt \\ &= \int 0 dt \\ &= C. \end{aligned}$$

Since $I(t)$ equals some constant C for all t , we can see that $I(0) = I(1)$, which will give us the value of the original integral:

$$\begin{aligned} I(0) &= \Re\left(\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} e^{0e^{ix}} dx\right) \\ &= \Re\left(\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} dx\right) \\ &= 2\pi. \end{aligned}$$